
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Real Easy English

Waste



This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Neil

Hello and welcome to Real Easy English. In this podcast, we have real conversations in easy English to help you learn. I'm Neil.

Beth

And I'm Beth. Did you know you can watch a video of this podcast on our website? Go to bbclearningenglish.com.

Neil

Hi Beth, how are you today?

Beth

I'm very good, thank you. Neil, how are you?

Neil

I'm very good. What are we talking about?

Beth

Well, today we are talking about **waste**. So that's what we call things that we don't want any more, like rubbish or things that we've used, and we now don't need them. So, for example, after I've eaten some crisps as a snack, the, the packet is rubbish, it's **waste**.

Neil

Are you good at dealing with **waste**?

Beth

I think so. I mean, at home we **recycle**. We can recycle glass, plastic, metal, card. All the usual things that we **recycle** here in the UK. What about you?

Neil

Yeah, I do what I'm supposed to do. So we have a separate bin for different things. For plastic and for glass and for paper and for food.

Beth

Yeah.

Neil

When I was a kid, everything went in the same bin.

Beth

Really?

Neil

Yeah. And now that seems really crazy and really bad.

Beth

Yeah.

Neil

So I think we are better now at dealing with **waste**, but probably there's more things we could do.

Beth

Yeah, I would think so. Yeah. Something that I do as well in, is when I'm in a supermarket, I try to not buy fruit and veg that's wrapped in plastic. I'll always try and buy the individual products like apples on their own. Or, you know, a courgette. You don't need a courgette that's wrapped in plastic.

Neil

Well, that's a good idea, but sometimes it's actually quite difficult to find things that aren't covered in plastic because we **rely on** plastic so much.

Beth

Yeah, I know that is true.

Neil

You know what people do these days, which is great that they didn't used to do. Carry reusable water bottles.

Beth

That's true.

Neil

Almost everybody carries a bottle. And just a few years ago, people bought plastic bottles of, of water all the time.

Beth

Yeah, I remember when I was teaching in a classroom and I'd sometimes have students. They would come to London from all over the world, and every day they would go to a supermarket and buy a plastic bottle. And I used to, I used to say sometimes, you know 'why, buy a reusable one' and then you're not using this plastic all the time.

Neil

Yeah. We have a word for that, don't we? **Single-use plastic.**

Beth

Yeah. So we have to try and avoid **single-use plastics**. What about water? So water **waste**. I really like having a bath just to relax, but sometimes I feel really guilty about it because it's using up quite a lot of water.

Neil

Yeah, I prefer showers, which is good because they use less water.

So, Beth, is there anything that you are planning to do to **cut down further on** the waste that you create?

Beth

I should probably have fewer baths. I mean, I maybe have one a week, so... I mean, I shower too, of course. But maybe I could have a bath less often. Find other ways of relaxing which are less wasteful. What about you? Anything you want to **cut back on**?

Neil

Yeah, I think, we talked about **single-use plastic**. You know, clingfilm, the very thin, like, sheet, sheets of plastic that you wrap food in.

Beth

Yeah.

Neil

I always feel bad when I use that stuff, but it's also really convenient and does its job well keeping a sandwich together or whatever. But I don't like it, so I want to **cut down on** my use of clingfilm.

Let's recap the vocabulary we heard in this conversation. We had **waste**. **Waste** is things that are unwanted like rubbish, and we can also describe something as **a waste** when someone uses something they don't need to, or they throw something away after not using it. So for example, when my kids don't finish their dinner, that's **a waste**.

Beth

We had **single-use plastics**. These are plastic materials that we use once and then throw away. So for example, food wrappers and shopping bags.

Neil

We heard **recycle** which means to collect rubbish in order to make materials that can be used again. We can also describe something as **recyclable**. It means it can be **recycled**. It can be used again.

Beth

And we heard some common phrasal verbs that we use when talking about the environment. So we had to **rely on** which means need something in order to function. For example, we **rely on** plastic a lot in our daily lives.

Neil

We can also say **cut down on** which means to reduce something. And we also hear **cut back on**. So for example I want to **cut back on single-use plastic**.

Beth

That's it for this episode of Real Easy English. If you want to learn more phrasal verbs about the environment, then Georgie has made a whole video on this. You'll find the link in the notes below.

Neil

And next time on Real Easy English, we'll be talking about confidence. See you then.

Beth

Bye.